Sharini Rao

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA
B.A. Data Science (Business Emphasis) — Expected May 2027
Berkeley Certificate in Design Innovation (In Progress) | SCET Certificate in Entrepreneurship & Technology (In Progress)

- **Relevant Coursework:** Human-Centered Product Design, Bio-Inspired Design, Data Structures, Probability & Statistics, Data Visualization, Data Mining and Analytics, Data Engineering

EXPERIENCE

Associate Strategy Consultant — Sep 2026 – Present
FEED (Food, Equity, Entrepreneurship, & Development) – Lotus Foods — Berkeley, CA

- Building an **EPR compliance framework** to help Lotus Foods leadership meet new packaging laws across **8 states**, by owning **all of Oregon's** research on packaging fees, plastic-reduction targets, and reporting rules.
- Designing a **packaging reporting tool (MVP)** to standardize multi-material disclosures across states, by consolidating state EPR requirements into one workflow with a focus on **LCA-based** fee exemptions.

Software Engineering Intern — May 2026 – Aug 2026
Legali AI — Berkeley, CA

- Shipped **6 production pages** and **3 core platform features** for an AI legal-help platform with **1,200+ quarterly active users**, by translating Figma designs into **Next.js, React, and Node.js**.
- Opened the platform's **12-question legal-help quiz** to non-English speakers and users with disabilities, so more people could reach legal support, by building multi-step state management across **7 languages** and meeting **WCAG** accessibility standards.
- Kept releases on track across **3 repositories** and **10+ merged PRs** despite shifting specs, by clarifying requirements with the CEO, designer, and senior engineer through iterative code review.

Data Analytics Research Apprentice — Jan 2026 – May 2026
UC Berkeley Haas School of Business (URAP) – Women's Health Nonprofit, India — Berkeley, CA

- Cut research reporting time by **4 weeks** for a women's health product study, by automating **Python (Pandas)** ETL workflows that consolidated raw multi-sheet trial data.
- Enabled regression analysis across **106 meeting locations** and **1,200+ participants**, by structuring control vs. treatment variables, auditing records for anomalies, and presenting findings to lead researchers.

Undergraduate Research Assistant — May 2024 – Sep 2025
Conolly Lab & Tikhomirov Lab (Bioengineering) — Berkeley, CA

- Developed **nanoparticle tracers** to sharpen **magnetic particle imaging** for medical imaging and biosensing, targeting **0.4 mT resolution** in water.

PRODUCT PROJECTS

Puffin: Drone Simulation Dashboard — Berkeley, CA
Class Project, CS 160 (User Interface Design) – Figma, Full-Stack Web — Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Replaced a fragmented 5-tool drone simulation setup with one browser dashboard, with **4 of 5** usability participants completing takeoff, by grounding the design in **4 needfinding interviews** and **5 usability sessions**.
- Shaped the dashboard's core user flows, by designing lo-fi screens and **Figma** prototypes and building the full-stack settings page.

Butterfly-Inspired Solar Fruit Dryer — Berkeley, CA
Project Lead, IB 130 (Bio-Inspired Design) – Arduino, Prototyping — Aug 2026 – Present

- Leading a **5-person team** to build a solar fruit dryer that cuts produce waste, by pitching the concept, writing the **project spec** from scratch, and delegating tasks by teammates' strengths.
- Enabling real-time monitoring of drying conditions in a design modeled on **black-and-white butterfly wings**, by leading the build of an **Arduino** temperature-sensing system.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

Society of Women Engineers (SWE) — Berkeley, CA
Evening with Industry Committee Officer — Aug 2025 – Present

- Brought **8 partner companies** to Berkeley's flagship technical networking conference (**60+ attendees**), by leading corporate sponsorship outreach and event logistics.

UC Berkeley Rec Well — Berkeley, CA
FitStaff Operations Lead — May 2024 – Present

- Keep a high-traffic campus gym running for **2.5+ years**, by leading **2–3 staff per shift** through openings, closings, and injuries.

SKILLS

- **Product:** User Research & Interviews, Usability Testing, Feature Prioritization, Stakeholder Management
- **Design:** Figma Prototyping, Wireframing, User Journey Mapping, Accessibility (WCAG)
- **Data & AI:** Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, Machine Learning, Regression (OLS), Data Visualization, LLM APIs (Claude)
- **Engineering:** JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, REST APIs, Git